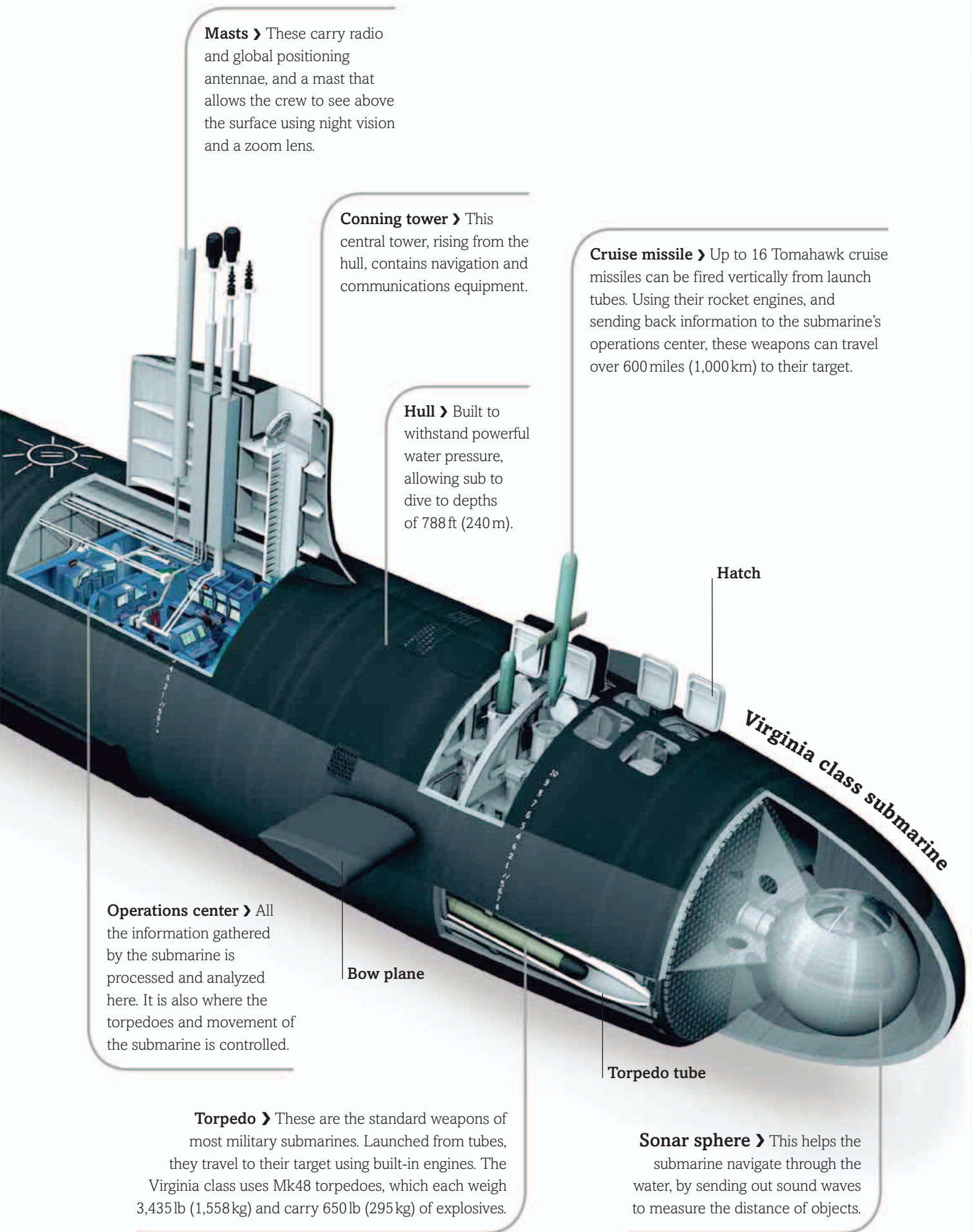




Masts > These carry radio and global positioning antennae, and a mast that allows the crew to see above the surface using night vision and a zoom lens.

Conning tower > This central tower, rising from the hull, contains navigation and communications equipment.

Cruise missile > Up to 16 Tomahawk cruise missiles can be fired vertically from launch tubes. Using their rocket engines, and sending back information to the submarine's operations center, these weapons can travel over 600 miles (1,000 km) to their target.

Hull > Built to withstand powerful water pressure, allowing sub to dive to depths of 788 ft (240 m).

Hatch

Virginia class submarine

Operations center > All the information gathered by the submarine is processed and analyzed here. It is also where the torpedoes and movement of the submarine is controlled.

Bow plane

Torpedo tube

Torpedo > These are the standard weapons of most military submarines. Launched from tubes, they travel to their target using built-in engines. The Virginia class uses Mk48 torpedoes, which each weigh 3,435 lb (1,558 kg) and carry 650 lb (295 kg) of explosives.

Sonar sphere > This helps the submarine navigate through the water, by sending out sound waves to measure the distance of objects.